double in 70 years if the growth rate is 1%. Thus, we divide 70 by the growth rate and we get the doubling time of population growth rate. For example if the growth rate is 2.08, divide 70 by 2.08 and we get 33.6 years as the doubling time of population.

World population has doubled in 40 years from 1959 (3 billion) to 1999 (6 billion). It is now estimated that it will take another nearly 40 years to increase by another 50% to become 9 billion by 2037. The latest world population projections indicate that world population will reach 10 billion persons in the year 2055 and 11 billion in the year 2088.

World Population Milestones

According to the United Nations, the 6 billion figure was reached on October 12, 1999 (celebrated as the Day of 6 Billion). World population reached 7 Billion on October 31, 2011. The current world population is 7.7 billion as of Feb 2019 according to the most recent United Nations estimates. The United Nations projects world population to reach 8 billion in 2023 and 10 billion in the year 2056.

Regional division on the basis of growth rate

On the basis of the growth rate of population the world can be divided into the following three types of areas:

1. Areas of Low Growth Rate

Developed countries like US, Canada, Japan, Australia, New Zealand and countries of western Europe have a low growth rate of population in these countries is due to low birth rates and low death rates. The difference between the birth rate and the death rate in these countries is the lowest.

2. Areas of Moderate Growth Rate

This category includes the developing countries like Pakistan, Afghanistan, Brazil, Bolivia, Mongolia, Indonesia and many other Africa and South American countries, where the growth rate of nearly 2 % is also included among these countries though the growth rate here has started declining.

3. Areas of High Growth Rate

Countries like Mexico, Iran, Colombia, Venezuela, Peru, Libya, Algeria, Sudan, Kenya and Kuwait make this category. In fact, most of the African countries with a growth rate of 3% fall in this category.

Population Concepts

i) **Over population:** situation whereby the population is considered too large for the available resources.

ii) **Under – population:** a situation where the population is less than the available resources of a country.

iii) **Optimum – population:** a situation where the number of people that can be supported is the same as the available resources.

Fact File

India - Population

- The current population of India is 1,363,413,725 as of Feb 19, 2019, based on the latest United Nations estimates.
- India population is 17.74% of the total world population.
- India ranks number 2 in the list of countries (and dependencies) by population.
- The population density in India is 455 per Km^2.(1180 persons/1mile)
- 33.6 % of the population is urban (460,249,853 people in 2019)

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